Akshay Danthi

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SUMMARY

AI product manager combining product judgment with hands-on experience building and evaluating 0-to-1 and enterprise AI products. Prioritizes high-value use cases and assesses tradeoffs through user research and experimentation, measuring success through AI quality, user adoption, and business impact.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Equifax Workforce Solutions (via Smartworks) Mar 2026 - Present

Technical Business Analyst

Drive product discovery and delivery across an enterprise AI and automation portfolio, modernizing customer support and internal operations through AI agents, workflow automation, and self-service capabilities.

Athena - AI Customer Support Agent:

- Owned Athena's product strategy and multiquarter roadmap; led its launch for **30 support specialists** handling **~3,000 monthly employment authorization cases**, targeting lower **Average Handle Time** (AHT) and higher **First-Contact Resolution (FCR)**.
- Developed **AI agent resolution playbooks** for **20 recurring case types**, combining LLM-based pattern mining and labeling of **~13,000 historical support cases** with specialist interviews and workshops to define resolution guidance, decision rules, tool-calling workflows, and human-review checkpoints.
- Coordinated delivery across the internal Salesforce and support operations teams to embed Athena in the case workspace and **integrate APIs** for E-Verify status checks and pending I-9 deletions, both requiring **human review**.
- Established Athena's **AI evaluation framework** and golden dataset for **groundedness, PII leakage, and tool-call correctness**; used offline LLM-as-a-judge evaluations to identify accuracy gaps and expand knowledge & tool coverage.
- Proposed and led development of a **top-k case retrieval feature**, retrieving K most similar resolved cases and their resolution notes for active cases to **address knowledge gaps** and enable a **resolution feedback loop**.
- Partnered with engineering to establish a **Spec-Driven Development workflow**, connecting versioned specifications to agent-generated plans, tasks, code, and tests, with staged human review.

EVA Conversational AI Voice Agent:

- Owned product requirements and shaped intent design to **modernize menu-driven IVR support** for The Work Number and Employer Services; defined **15+ intent workflows** so callers can state their needs naturally, receive automated answers, or reach the right live-agent queue with their request context.
- Defined and tracked EVA's success KPIs, targeting **30% lower average hold time**, **90%+ intent recognition accuracy**, and **95% routing accuracy**; prepared for launch with **15 red-team test scenarios** and phased rollout.

AD Consulting Sep 2024 - Mar 2026

AI Product Builder

- Owned end-to-end AI product development across 3 client engagements in VC, FinTech, and EdTech, spanning user discovery, product strategy, roadmap definition, hands-on prototyping of **RAG and agentic workflows**, technical tradeoff decisions, LLM evaluation, and delivery.
- **TheSprintFit**: Led 0-to-1 development of an AI platform for VC deal screening and founder-investor matching, **cutting deal evaluation time by ~70%**; defined the RAG evaluation strategy and quality gates across groundedness, hallucination, relevance, and retrieval quality, **improving grounding by 34%** and **reducing hallucinations by 62%**.
- **SowFin**: Led discovery and development of a self-service GenAI analytics product for CFOs, interviewing 15 finance leaders and **converting 40% to paid pilots**; built a fine-tuned Llama 3.2 3B model at **92% contextual accuracy**.
- **Majorly**: Led development of a real-time AI interview simulator, shaping conversational UX and technical requirements around response latency and interview realism; drove a **20% increase in weekly active usage within 6 weeks** and converted **3 pilots to paid customers**.

Mastercard *(via Wipro)* Mar 2022 - Aug 2023

Technical Product Manager

- Led the transformation of Mastercard's card program configuration platform into a self-service tool for issuer-facing teams, increasing onboarding **throughput by 5x** from **10 to 50+ organizations** per week.
- Defined the **prioritization strategy** for integrating 6 high-impact business capabilities into the self-service platform, including Tokenization, Risk Analytics, Loyalty, based on **business value, operational friction, integration readiness**.
- Drove **roadmap execution** across 15+ global stakeholders and a 9-person cross-functional team, balancing market-specific business and regulatory requirements to deliver iterative releases that achieved an **85% CSAT**.

HSBC *(via Infosys)* Nov 2019 - Mar 2022

Technical Business Analyst

- Elicited and analyzed business and regulatory requirements for HSBC's payments modernization in the UK & Saudi Arabia, including ISO 20022 transformation, Bacs enhancements, and mandated digital signatures for wage payments.
- Drove end-to-end business analysis across the transformation, including as-is/to-be process analysis, payment message mapping, requirements workshops, user stories, acceptance criteria, UAT, and release readiness.

Lloyds Banking Group *(via Virtusa)* Nov 2017 - Nov 2019

Software Engineer

- Built and maintained **Java** and **Oracle SQL** components for *Payments Control Manager*, supporting payment configuration and processing workflows for **100K+ daily** SWIFT transactions.
- Diagnosed defects, delivered code enhancements, supported testing, and resolved production issues for payment applications, collaborating with Business Analysts, QA, support, and upstream/downstream engineering teams.

EDUCATION

- M.S. in **Business Analytics** (Golden Gate University, San Francisco, CA) Sep 2023 - Sep 2024
- B.E. in **Computer Science** (Anna University, Chennai, India) Aug 2013 - Aug 2017

SKILLS

AI Product Management: Product strategy, 0-to-1 product development, user discovery, roadmap prioritization, KPI definition, product analytics, experimentation, AI product evaluation, stakeholder management

GenAI & LLM Systems: RAG, agentic workflows, Model Context Protocol (MCP), agent tool integration, LLM evaluation, LLM as a judge, prompt engineering, groundedness, hallucination testing, guardrails, PII controls, AI architecture tradeoffs

Technical Product & Business Analysis: PRD Development, backlog management, JTBD, Agile delivery, systems integration, journey mapping, Spec Driven Development, API integration analysis, UAT prep, release readiness, knowledge governance

Data & Analytics: Python, SQL, Pandas, LLM-assisted thematic analysis, product analytics, data visualization

Tools & Platforms: Salesforce, Google Cloud, LangGraph, ADK, Langfuse, Jira,Confluence, Google CCAI, Cursor, Claude Code

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified **AI/ML Product Management** (*AI Product Strategy, LLMOps, Pricing GenAI models*) - PMExercises (2024)
- **Generative AI Leader** *(Google Cloud GenAI, Model Output Optimization, GenAI Strategy)* - Google Cloud (2026)